

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 3
♥ J 10 6 3
♦ Q 10 9 3
♣ J 4

♠ A Q 6
♥ K 9
♦ K 6 5 4
♣ A K 10 9



♠ K J 7 5 4 2
♥ A 8 4
♦ 7
♣ 8 7 2

♠ 8
♥ Q 7 5 2
♦ A J 8 2
♣ Q 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

fact that most of your strength is in the black suits should help you decide on 3NT.

You have 19 points, too much for 1NT. With two 4-card minors you should open 1♦, regardless of strength. Partner responds 1♥.

Partner's ♥ bid makes you very happy. It also makes your rebid a snap. With 19 points and a balanced hand you jump to 2NT.

Partner now surprises you a little by saying 3♦.

What is your next bid?

For partner to take you out of Notrump he must have a distributional hand, probably with a singleton or void in one of the black suits. You have to make the choice between passing, bidding 4♦ or 5♦, or bidding 3NT.

While any of those choices might turn out best, the

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠5. West plays the ♠9.

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Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 4? : Total = 8?

Those 4 ♣ winners assume a 3-2 split. Since that is going to be the first suit you play you will find out soon enough.

You win the ♠Q. Play the ♣K, then the ♣10 (trying to tempt a cover). Go up with the ♣Q and West follows with the ♣J so you do have 4 ♣ tricks. Take your other two ♣s right now.

You are now at the crossroads. For your ninth trick should you try the ♦ finesse or should you establish a ♥. It's a no-brainer. If you finesse a ♦ and it loses to West's ♦Q a ♠ will come back, knocking out your last stopper. Then, if the ♦s fail to split 3-2 you will be short one winner and it will be too late to set up the ♥. So ignore the finesse and set up a ♥ for your guaranteed nine tricks.

As you can see, with this layout a ♦ finesse would be fatal.

West would win and play a ♠, and whether you ducked this one or not your last stopper would soon be removed. When ♦s failed to split 3-2 you would have been forced to try a ♥. East would win his ♥A and set you with ♠s.

Correctly played you would lead a ♥ honor to establish one trick in the suit and easily make the game with 2 ♠s, 1 ♥, 2 ♦s and 4 ♣s.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 4
 ♥ A 6
 ♦ 9 8 6 5 3
 ♣ Q 8 4 2

♠ 10 9 3

♥ 9 2

♦ A Q 10 4

♣ A J 7 3



♠ A K J 8 6 2

♥ K 7 4

♦ 2

♣ K 6 5

♠ 7 5

♥ Q J 10 8 5 3

♦ K J 7

♣ 10 9

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	3 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			

4 ♠ by East

be the ♥ which you can ruff in dummy. However, North's ♥9 looks a little ominous, particularly since South apparently has some length in the suit. Presumably you played the ♥A on the first trick. Next lead the ♥6 from dummy, hoping North can't (or doesn't) ruff. He plays the ♥2. Win the ♥K and play your ♥4, ruffing with dummy's ♠Q. North is out of ♥s, but can't over-ruff. Now pull trumps and set up one ♣ trick. You lose 2 ♣s and a ♦, just as expected.

Ruffing with the ♠Q might cost a trick if the ♠s split 4-1 and North did not have a doubleton ♥. But you need to stay flexible and make your decisions based on what you see happening at the table. In this deal, after North signalled high-low in ♥s it was logical to play him for a doubleton.

An easy one. You bid 1 ♠. Partner responds 1NT.

What is your next bid?

You're going to rebid your 6-card ♠ suit, but how high? The usual guideline is to bid 2 ♠ with 13-15 points, but jump to 3 ♠ with 16-18 points. You come in just over the line so you bid 3 ♠. Partner puts it in game.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You must eliminate one loser and the easiest one will be the ♥ which you can ruff in dummy. However, North's ♥9 looks a little ominous, particularly since South apparently has some length in the suit. Presumably you played the ♥A on the first trick. Next lead the ♥6 from dummy, hoping North can't (or doesn't) ruff. He plays the ♥2. Win the ♥K and play your ♥4, ruffing with dummy's ♠Q. North is out of ♥s, but can't over-ruff. Now pull trumps and set up one ♣ trick. You lose 2 ♣s and a ♦, just as expected.